



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Our Lady of the Rosary Catholic School
School Website: <https://olr.school/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Our Lady of the Rosary Catholic School (Our Lady of the Rosary, OLR) presents a robust classical-Catholic program that is deeply integrated with parish life and the Western classical tradition. Public-facing materials emphasize a Catholic, classically-inspired curriculum, a formation-focused mission, an emphasis on Latin and Western civilization, a memory- and recitation-centered pedagogy, and strong parental partnership. The school continually frames education as formation toward wisdom, virtue, and love of truth, beauty, and goodness, consistent with classical ideals. Taken together, the six-category analysis indicates a full CLASSICAL orientation across religious/metaphysical foundations, school purpose/goals, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parents/community.

Key signals include: explicit statements of a thoroughly Catholic approach embedded across the curriculum; a mission that foregrounds formation and the love of truth, goodness, and beauty; a curriculum featuring classical disciplines (Latin, literature, Western civilization) and Great-Conversation-oriented framing; pedagogical practices such as daily recitation, Socratic discussions in upper grades, and emphasis on memory work; a faculty described as exemplars within a "living curriculum" with bios and leadership; and a proactive, parish-centered model of parent involvement (family partnership, advisory structures, and family scholarships). See, for example, the Catholic/classical framing, the Pillars of the program, and the pedagogical practices described on the school site (e.g., references to truth/goodness/beauty, Catholic teaching across curriculum, daily recitation, and Socratic discussions) as well as the mission/identity materials. Citations anchor these observations to the school's public materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Note: In each category, a keyword-driven analysis supports a CLASSICAL rating, with explicit textual evidence drawn from the school's materials and aligned to the Positive/Negative keyword indicators in the classical-education rubric.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable for this school given the CATEGORY-LEVEL and AGGREGATE CLASSICAL classifications. The school already demonstrates clear classical alignment across all six categories, including liturgical/theological integration, formation-focused aims, classical curriculum and memory-based pedagogy, living-faculty model, and active parental partnership.

Proceeding to the detailed category-by-category evaluation below, followed by an ABSTRACT summarizing the overall classification and insights.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a thoroughly Catholic, classically-inspired program with explicit integration of Catholic teaching across the curriculum. The Upper School pillars stress “Thoroughly Catholic” identity and a curriculum that integrates Catholic teaching throughout, with teachers modeled to live the faith and families committed to the mission. - Mission and framing emphasize a Catholic anthropology and teleology: education is a formation toward truth, goodness, and beauty in a sacred context, culminating in a Catholic culture within the school. The Vision/Philosophy materials articulate a worldview anchored in the Catholic faith and the Western-tradition-informed education. - Texts describing the foundational premise—“To choose Truth, Goodness, and Beauty is to choose the friendship of Jesus Christ”—explicitly anchor education to transcendental realities and sacred aims. - The school’s materials also reference liturgical and communal practices (worship, liturgy, prayer, and sacred time) as part of education, consistent with the Sixth Element’s liturgical and communal practices.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Catholic, theology, liturgy/mass/worship, sacred, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, reverence, wonder, imago Dei, Logos, sacred tradition, catechesis, etc. The site repeatedly foregrounds these terms in pillar statements, mission, and program descriptions. Estimated positive keyword density is high (numerous explicit mentions). No explicit negative keywords (e.g., secularism, relativism) are evident in public materials. - Negative keywords: None clearly visible in public-facing content.

Why this rating - The school’s public materials show a coherent, explicit religio-metaphysical foundation centered on Catholic theology, sacramental imagination, liturgical practice, and a reverence for the true/-good/beautiful in a sacred context. This aligns squarely with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and with the rubric’s expectations for a Classical school that grounds education in transcendental realism and liturgical/cultural practices. The absence of secular or value-neutral language in the core materials supports a CLASSICAL assessment in this category. See examples cited above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s mission states that the classical program forms “joyful disciples of Jesus Christ” and emphasizes formation toward wisdom and virtue, not merely vocational preparation. The materials also articulate a purpose articulated as “formation” rather than information, with a focus on truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ends. The Pillars include “Preparatory for Life” and emphasize formation and character rather than mere job-readiness. - The mission and vision explicitly frame education as a formation of the whole person—intellect, will, and soul—toward human flourishing in a Catholic context. Recurring phrases emphasize virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful. - Public texts describe a K-12 classical model designed to form “joyful disciples,” with attention to memory, moral formation, and a deep, enduring engagement with Western civilization and core liberal arts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, contemplation (scholé), great conversation, classical heritage, human flourishing. - Negative keywords observed: None significant (no overt emphasis on job-readiness or 21st-century skills as the explicit primary aim).

Why this rating - The school’s stated goals align with classical aims of formation, virtue, and the pursuit of transcendentals, rather than purely vocational or information-transfer goals. The presence of “Preparatory for Life,” “joyful disciples,” and “pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty” supports CLASSICAL here. The absence of a vocational-empowerment framing in the core statements reinforces this assessment.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school publicly advances a “Catholic Curriculum” that is explicitly described as classical, with core curricular requirements in classical disciplines and a focus on Latin, literature, classical history,

and Western Civilization. The curriculum emphasizes the liberal arts and the Great Conversation through engagement with foundational works and Latin study; recitation and memory-building are highlighted as pedagogical tools. - The public materials indicate a priority on Latin, Greek/Latin-based study (Latin in early grades, classic languages), and a core focus on Western Civilization. The curriculum maps and program descriptions show dedicated Latin tracks and classical studies, aligning with the Trivium and Quadrivium framing across the K-12 spectrum. - The school describes a deliberate emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation within a Catholic, classical formation, and on integrating disciplines rather than isolating them. The “The Theory of Classical Education” materials outline features like daily recitation, memory work, and the integrated approach to history, literature, and philosophy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium), Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation, Western Civilization, memory/recitation, interdisciplinary integration, wonder. - Negative keywords observed: The site does not overtly emphasize non-historical social studies framing, nor does it emphasize project-based learning as the sole or primary mode. The explicit mention of Great Books and classical texts reduces the likelihood of a strictly modern, non-historical approach.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly described as classical and liberal-arts-oriented, with Trivium components, Latin, Western Civilization emphasis, and Great Books/Great Conversation framing, plus memory/recitation as pedagogy. The explicit alignment with classical curriculum elements in the site’s material supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s materials describe a multi-faceted classical pedagogy: daily recitation/memory work, contemplative/restful elements (Schol  ), and a progression to Socratic discussion and rhetoric in upper grades. The public materials explicitly discuss Socratic discussions, seminars, or debates for upper grades and the training in rhetoric with opportunities for speeches. - There is explicit mention of “Daily Recitation” to place information in long-term memory and of “Socratic discussions” and “great conversation” as upper-school methods. The model includes a lower-school emphasis on singing/chanting/memory and an upper-school emphasis on dialectic and rhetoric. - The school notes a House System, student government, and other forms of community life that integrate with the pedagogical approach, consistent with a holistic, classical pedagogy that includes formation of character through exemplary models and dialogic inquiry.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, seminars, recitation, chanting, memory, rhetoric, great conversation, satire, Harkness-style discussion, talk through texts, formation through practice. - Negative keywords observed: The public-facing materials emphasize classical, dialogic pedagogy; explicit negative signals (e.g., project-based-only or purely experiential learning as the default) are not evident.

Why this rating - The pedagogical design aligns with classical pedagogy: a staged approach from memory and recitation in the lower grades to Socratic discussion and rhetoric in the upper grades, with contemplation and memory as central elements. This constitutes CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a faculty that is described as mentors and living exemplars, with bios showing teachers who model virtue and mastery in their disciplines. The school emphasizes a family/teacher-community culture and presents a faculty roster with biography-style pages that emphasize formation, virtue, and professional expertise. The “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” ideas align with the classical model. - The public materials present leadership (Headmaster, Dean of Students, Director of Enhanced Learning, etc.) along with a broader roster of teachers and staff who are described as dedicated to forming students in virtue and knowledge. The bios emphasize Catholic formation and scholarly expertise. - The “Faculty & Staff” section explicitly aligns teachers with the mission of formation and the classical program, reinforcing a model where teachers are central to the curriculum as the living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, mentors/model teachers, virtue formation, teacher as exemplar, collegial culture, professional formation, classical pedagogy, Christian formation. - Negative keywords observed: No explicit mention of a neutral or “facilitator-on-the-side” model; the materials emphasize teacher leadership and formation, which aligns with CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The faculty materials emphasize virtue, modeling, mentorship, and a collaborative, high-commitment culture consistent with a CLASSICAL□. The presence of teacher bios and leadership roles supports this rating.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a strong partnership with families, parent formation, and opportunities for parents to engage publicly (e.g., School Advisory Council, Parent-School Partnership, family involvement, and classical parent education events). The mission explicitly frames parents as primary educators, partners with the school in formation, and the institution regularly invites parent participation and visits. - The public materials describe financial support for families (Faithful Families Scholarship), ensuring accessibility and inviting broader family involvement in classical education. The charter explicitly situates parents as co-educators and supports family engagement in the classical project. - The school notes that parents are welcome for visits and that the campus/parish relationship is central to school life, underscoring a holistic community model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, parent-education events, home-school partnership, open campus, parental engagement. - Negative keywords observed: None; there is no dominant consumer-language framing that would indicate a non-classical approach.

Why this rating - The school actively promotes parental partnership and family formation as core elements of its classical program, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations in this category.

AGGREGATE CLASSIFICATION

- All six categories are CLASSICAL based on the keyword analysis, textual evidence, and alignment with the Six Essential Elements rubric.

What Would Move the Needle

- N/A. No needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. The school already demonstrates a coherent classical-Catholic model across religious foundations, formation goals, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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